	PROCEDURE TO HANDLE CONTRACTUAL MATTERS- REVIEW OF CONTRACTS, TENDERS, AND CUSTOMER REQUESTS	
	Document no: ASMF4.7.1	
Compiled by:	**Sifiso Nyambi - Laboratory Manager**	
Approved by:	**Nonhlanhla Msibi - Operations Manager**	

Document Title: Procedure to handle the review of Contracts, Tenders, and Customer Requests

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Responsible Person(s): Operations Manager and Laboratory Manager/Supervisor

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Effective date	Rev status	Next review date
07/2025	00	07/2028

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1. Purpose

To ensure that all contractual agreements concerning the production of reference material and provision of proficiency testing scheme are reviewed and agreed upon prior to acceptance, verifying that the laboratory has the competence and resources to meet the specified requirements.

2. Scope

Apply to all incoming contracts, tenders, and/or customer requests for coal or coke analysis/ purchasing of Certified Reference Material (CRM) and/or participation in Proficiency Testing (PT) scheme.

3. Procedure

3.1. Reception of Request

The sales/technical team receives the customer inquiry, RFQ, or tender document.

3.2. Initial Review

The laboratory supervisor/manager and operations manager use the contract review checklist (ASMF4.1.2) to assess the required test methods (e.g., ISO 1171, ISO 562 etc.).

- NB: It is required that the review checklist to be used together with request/tender checklist (if it is attached) define and agree on PT objectives with customer (ie. use a legal document) which will not be limited to the following:

- Timelines of PT sample shipping and report issuing,

- Type and number of samples - RM specifications (CRM used, expected value ranges).
- Stability requirements (sample degradation over time).
- Homogeneity (sample consistency across splits, where applicable).
- Metrological traceability (link to SI units or certified values).
- Turnaround time (shipping requirements).
- Confidentiality and impartiality risks.

3.3. Capability Assessment

- Check available equipment, staff competency, and workload.
- If outsourcing is required, note it and ensure the subcontractor is approved. Ensure that the client is notified of the subcontracting and get approval before dispatching samples.

3.4. Customer Clarification

Ensure that any unclear or conflicting specifications are clarified in writing with the customer.

3.5. Contract Approval

Once requirements are understood and accepted, both parties shall sign the agreement:

- Contract is logged and stored in Contract Review Register (ASMF4.1.4)
- Related documents are stored electronically under the project code.

3.6. Communication

Define and agree on modes of communication, frequency of communication and relevant personnel to liaise with

- Ensure that a written statement is communicated through email to all relevant parties regarding the decision rule.

Inform relevant departments (preparation, analyst, management) of new contracts and requirements.

Customer shall be informed of any deviation from the legal agreement including any pertinent information regarding customer requirements.

3.7. Contract amendment

Ensure that contract review is performed after any amendment has been agreed with the customer. Use the contract review checklist (ASMF4.1.2) and assess eg. Personnel capability, equipment capability, etc

4. Record Keeping

- Completed Contract Review Checklist (ASMF4.1.2)
- Email confirmations or clarifications with customers
- Capability assessment records eg. Training records, equipment evaluation records, etc
- Signed contracts or tenders
- Register of all contract reviews (ASMF4.1.4)
- Complete the risk assessment form and define risks which could impair the provision of services, chatagorise the risks and define mitigation measures. Risk assessment template ASMF 8.5.3

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5. Checklist Extract

Item	Yes	No	N/A	Comments
Method requested known/validated?				ISO [number] specified
CRM required?				CRM [assigned value] used
Homogeneity assessed?				Sample split test documented?
Sample stability conditions stated?				<23°C, 25-45% RH
Metrological traceability required?				CRM traceable to BIPM standard (SI unit)
Lab competent & equipped?				[Equipment name], staff trained

6. Revision table

Revision no	Content changed	Reason for revision

Effective date	Rev status	Next review date
07/2025	00	07/2028